IBM® Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On
Version 8.2.1

Policies Definition Guide

SC23-9694-04

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Note

Before using this information and the product it supports, read the information in "Notices" on page 137.

Edition notice

Note: This edition applies to version 8.2.1 of IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On, (product number 5724–V67) and to all subsequent releases and modifications until otherwise indicated in new editions.

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About this publication

IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Policies Definition Guide provides detailed descriptions of the different user, machine, and system policies that Administrators can configure in AccessAdmin. Use this guide along with the IBM® Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Administrator Guide.

Access to publications and terminology

This section provides:

- A list of publications in the "IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On library."
- Links to "Online publications" on page viii.
- A link to the "IBM Terminology website" on page viii.

IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On library

The following documents are available in the IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On library:

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Quick Start Guide*, CF3T3ML

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Quick Start Guide provides a quick start on the main installation and configuration tasks to deploy and use IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On.
- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Planning and Deployment Guide*, SC23995206

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Planning and Deployment Guide contains information about planning your deployment and preparing your environment. It provides an overview of the product features and components, the required installation and configuration, and the different deployment scenarios. It also describes how to achieve high availability and disaster recovery. Read this guide before you do any installation or configuration tasks.
- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Installation Guide*, GI11930904

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Installation Guide provides detailed procedures on installation, upgrade, or uninstallation of IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On.

  This guide helps you to install the different product components and their required middleware. It also includes the initial configurations that are required to complete the product deployment. It covers procedures for using WebSphere® Application Server Base editions, and Network Deployment.
- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Configuration Guide*, GC23969204

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Configuration Guide provides information about configuring the IMS Server settings, the AccessAgent user interface, and its behavior.
- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Administrator Guide*, SC23995105

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This guide is intended for the Administrators. It covers the different Administrator tasks. *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Administrator Guide* provides procedures for creating and assigning policy templates, editing policy values, generating logs and reports, and backing up the IMS Server and its database. Use this guide together with the IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Policies Definition Guide.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Policies Definition Guide*, SC23969404

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Policies Definition Guide provides detailed descriptions of the different user, machine, and system policies that Administrators can configure in AccessAdmin. Use this guide along with the IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Administrator Guide.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Help Desk Guide*, SC23995304

  This guide is intended for Help desk officers. *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Help Desk Guide* provides Help desk officers information about managing queries and requests from users usually about their authentication factors. Use this guide together with the IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Policies Definition Guide.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On User Guide*, SC23995005

  This guide is intended for the users. *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On User Guide* provides instructions for using AccessAgent and Web Workplace.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Troubleshooting and Support Guide*, GC23969303

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Troubleshooting and Support Guide provides information about issues with regards to installation, upgrade, and product usage. This guide covers the known issues and limitations of the product. It helps you determine the symptoms and workaround for the problem. It also provides information about fixes, knowledge bases, and support.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Error Message Reference Guide*, GC14762402

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Error Message Reference Guide describes all the informational, warning, and error messages that are associated with IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessStudio Guide*, SC23995605

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessStudio Guide provides information about creating and using AccessProfiles. This guide provides procedures for creating and editing standard and advanced AccessProfiles for different application types. It also covers information about managing authentication services and application objects, and information about other functions and features of AccessStudio.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessProfile Widgets Guide*, SC27444401

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessProfile Widgets Guide provides information about creating and using widgets.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Tivoli Endpoint Manager Integration Guide*, SC27562000

IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Tivoli Endpoint Manager Integration Guide provides information about how to create and deploy Fixlets for AccessAgent installation, upgrade or patch management. It also includes topics about using and customizing the dashboard to view information about AccessAgent deployment on the endpoints.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Provisioning Integration Guide*, SC23995704

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Provisioning Integration Guide provides information about the different Java™ and SOAP API for provisioning. It also covers procedures for installing and configuring the Provisioning Agent.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Web API for Credential Management Guide*, SC14764601

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Web API for Credential Management Guide provides information about installing and configuring the Web API for credential management.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Serial ID SPI Guide*, SC14762601

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Serial ID SPI Guide describes how to integrate any device with serial numbers and use it as a second authentication factor with AccessAgent.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Epic Integration Guide*, SC27562300

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Epic Integration Guide provides information about the IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On and Epic integration, including supported workflows, configurations, and deployment.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Context Management Integration Guide*, SC23995404

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Context Management Integration Guide provides information about installing, configuring, and testing the Context Management integrated solution in each client workstation.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessAgent on Mobile Guide*, SC27562101

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessAgent on Mobile Guide provides information about the deployment and use of single sign-on on mobile devices.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessAgent on Virtual Desktop Infrastructure Guide*, SC27562201

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessAgent on Virtual Desktop Infrastructure Guide provides information about setting up single sign-on support on a Virtual Desktop Infrastructure, and the different user workflows for accessing the virtual desktop.

- *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessAgent on Terminal Server and Citrix Server Guide*, SC27566801

  IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On AccessAgent on Terminal Server and Citrix Server Guide provides information about the required configurations and supported workflows in the Terminal and Citrix Servers.

Online publications

IBM posts product publications when the product is released and when the publications are updated at the following locations:

IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On library
The product documentation site (http://pic.dhe.ibm.com/infocenter/tivihelp/v2r1/index.jsp?topic=/com.ibm.itamesso.doc_8.2.1/kc-homepage.html) displays the welcome page and navigation for the library.

IBM Security Systems Documentation Central
IBM Security Systems Documentation Central provides an alphabetical list of all IBM Security Systems product libraries and links to the online documentation for specific versions of each product.

IBM Publications Center
IBM Publications Center offers customized search functions to help you find all the IBM publications you need.

IBM Terminology website

The IBM Terminology website consolidates terminology for product libraries in one location. You can access the Terminology website at http://www.ibm.com/software/globalization/terminology.

Accessibility

Accessibility features help users with a physical disability, such as restricted mobility or limited vision, to use software products successfully. With this product, you can use assistive technologies to hear and navigate the interface. You can also use the keyboard instead of the mouse to operate all features of the graphical user interface.

For additional information, see "Accessibility features" in the *IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Planning and Deployment Guide*.

Technical training

For technical training information, see the following IBM Education website at http://www.ibm.com/software/tivoli/education.

Support information

IBM Support provides assistance with code-related problems and routine, short duration installation or usage questions. You can directly access the IBM Software Support site at http://www.ibm.com/software/support/probsub.html.

IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On Troubleshooting and Support Guide provides details about:

- What information to collect before contacting IBM Support.
- The various methods for contacting IBM Support.
- How to use IBM Support Assistant.
- Instructions and problem-determination resources to isolate and fix the problem yourself.

Note: The **Community and Support** tab on the product information center can provide additional support resources.

Statement of Good Security Practices

IT system security involves protecting systems and information through prevention, detection and response to improper access from within and outside your enterprise. Improper access can result in information being altered, destroyed, misappropriated or misused or can result in damage to or misuse of your systems, including for use in attacks on others. No IT system or product should be considered completely secure and no single product, service or security measure can be completely effective in preventing improper use or access. IBM systems, products and services are designed to be part of a comprehensive security approach, which will necessarily involve additional operational procedures, and may require other systems, products or services to be most effective. IBM DOES NOT WARRANT THAT ANY SYSTEMS, PRODUCTS OR SERVICES ARE IMMUNE FROM, OR WILL MAKE YOUR ENTERPRISE IMMUNE FROM, THE MALICIOUS OR ILLEGAL CONDUCT OF ANY PARTY.

Chapter 1. Policies in AccessAdmin

IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On uses policies to control the behavior of its product components.

The policies are configurable to meet specific organizational requirements. Policies have different visibilities and scopes, and are managed by different roles.

Each policy is identified by its policy ID with *pid* in the prefix. For example, `pid_wallet_authentication_option`.

System, machine, and user policies are configured in AccessAdmin.

Machine policies are typically configured in AccessAdmin. You can also configure machine policies in the Windows registry specially when the `pid_machine_policy_override_enabled` policy is set to **Yes**.

An Administrator can modify system and machine policies in AccessAdmin. A Help desk officer can view system and machine policies only. An Administrator or Help desk officer can modify user policies.

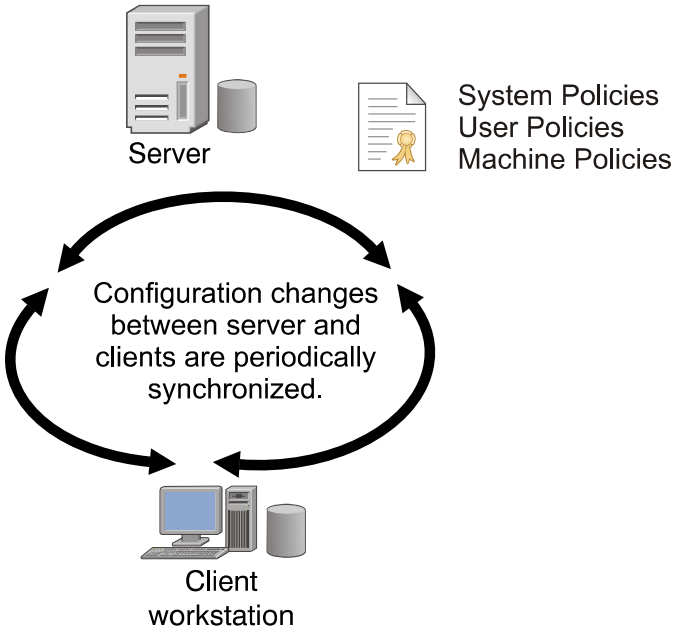

Figure 1. An overview of how different policies are synchronized between client and server in IBM Security Access Manager for Enterprise Single Sign-On.

Scope

The applicability of a policy is determined by scope.

- **System**: The policy is applicable to all users and machines.
- **User**: The policy affects a specific user.
- **Machine**: The policy affects a specific computer.

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Take note of the following information.

- A policy might be defined for multiple scopes. If this policy is defined for two scopes, set a priority in case the timeout value is different for the computer and the entire system. For more information about setting policy priorities, see Chapter 3, "Viewing and setting policy priorities," on page 5.
- Changes to these policies are propagated to the components the next time AccessAgent synchronizes with the IMS Server.
- User policy, if defined, overrides system policy.

There are three ways to edit user policies in AccessAdmin.

- Search for the user and in the page of the user, go to the appropriate policy section, and update the policy.
- Search for a group of users and in the search result, update the policy, and apply to selected users.
- Update a User Policy Template and apply it to one or more users.

Dependencies

Policies might be dependent on other policies. For example, `pid_enc_hot_key_action` is only effective if `pid_enc_hot_key_enabled` is set to **True**. If the latter is set to **False**, any setting for `pid_enc_hot_key_action` does not affect users. The dependencies are described in the later sections

User-specific policies generally override system-wide policies, but this setting also depends on the policy priority. For example, the Authentication accounts maximum policy (`pid_auth_accounts_max`) has both user and system scopes. The user scope setting is always effective if it is defined. If the user scope setting is not defined for a user, the system scope setting becomes effective.

In general, application-specific policies override authentication service-specific policies, which in turn, override general Wallet policies. The Wallet inject password entry option default policy (`pid_wallet_inject_pwd_entry_option_default`) is used when the other two policies are not defined for a particular authentication service or application. See Chapter 13, "Policies for Applications and Authentication Services," on page 115 for more details.

Chapter 2. Policy legends

Policies can be modified only by Help desk officers and Administrators. Policies affect the behavior of the whole system and must be modified only when it is necessary. These policies must be set at deployment and followed through.

Attribute	Description
✓	Frequently used policies
Policy ID	Unique identifier of the policy.
IMS Entry	The entry in the IMS Server for System and User policies. If this column is blank, the value must be set in the registry. If not, the value indicates the name of the policy, which can be set in the IMS Server.
Description	Description of the policy, including a list of the possible behaviors that are specified by the policy. The product version that implements this policy is also indicated.
Location	Specifies the location of the policy. • For new policies: – **AccessAdmin** > **User Policy Templates** > **New template** > **Create new policy template** – **AccessAdmin** > **Machine Policy Templates** > **New template** > **Create new machine policy template** – **AccessAdmin** > **System** > **System policies** • For existing policies: – **AccessAdmin** > **User Policy Templates** > **<*template name*>** > **Policy template details** – **AccessAdmin** > **Machine Policy Templates** > **<*template name*>** > **Policy template details** – **AccessAdmin** > **System** > **System policies** • For registry entries: – **Registry Editor** > **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE** > **SOFTWARE** > **IBM** > **ISAM ESSO**
Registry	The entry in the Windows Registry (for Machine policies) or the IMS Server (for System, User, and Machine policies): • `[DO]` is `[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\IBM\ISAM ESSO\DeploymentOptions]` • `[DIMS]` is `[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\IBM\ISAM ESSO\IMSService\DefaultIMSSettings]` • `[GIMS]` is `[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\IBM\ISAM ESSO\IMSService\GlobalIMSSettings]` • `[T]` is `[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\IBM\ISAM ESSO\Temp]`
Type	The data type of this policy in the IMS Server or Windows Registry.
Values	Possible values of the policy. The default value is used if the policy is not specified or if the specified value is not correct.

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Attribute	Description
Scope	The scope of applicability of the policy. **Values:** • **System**: Policy is system-wide • **Machine**: Policy affects only a specific machine • **User**: Policy affects only a specific user
Note	The refresh frequency is indicated here. This value indicates when a policy will be effective after it is changed. • **Refreshed on use**: Policy that is read from the IMS Server or registry every time it is used. Changes, for example, are effective immediately. • **Refreshed on sync**: Policy that is read from the IMS Server or registry entry only on the next synchronization with the IMS Server. • **Refreshed on logon**: Policy that is read from the IMS Server or registry entry only on the next AccessAgent logon. • **Refreshed on startup**: Policy that is read from the IMS Server or registry entry only on system startup.